'Local-first' — the term

Private. All times MT. Anchor A = Jeff's Gemini chat 2026-09-18 10:16 MDT (VERIFIED); B = 2026-09-19 00:00 MDT (Jeff's CLAIMED first sighting, 09-19/20). Days = Jeff minus theirs (minus = Jeff first). Colours vs A: purple ≤7 d (overrides), grey date-only, green Jeff first, amber they first ≤30 d, red >30 d.

Honest framing: the term 'local-first' predates Jeff by years — informal technical uses on HN from 2014, the defining Ink & Switch essay on 2019-05-01 (about 7.4 years earlier), the Onward! 2019 paper, and a community/site/podcast/conference ecosystem since 2023–24. In 15–22 Sep 2026 the term was everyday vocabulary: 21 HN stories and many X posts (mostly low-engagement). Nothing shows which, if any, Jeff saw; the window list is 'plausible exposure', not evidence. Timing is not causation.

1. Earliest public uses

Item	Date MT	vs A	vs B	Colour	Link	Label
HN comment by mamcx: POS app whose 'data is local-first and sync with the cloud' (SQLite) — earliest technical use found	2014-05-16 07:04:59 MDT	+4508.1	+4508.7	red	https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=7755211	VERIFIED (HN Algolia timestamp)
HN comment by e12e: 'do search local-first' over SQLite full-text search + sync (pre-2019, informal)	2014-11-13 04:17:48 MST	+4327.2	+4327.8	red	https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=8600941	VERIFIED (HN Algolia timestamp)
Non-software senses: 'Local First' shop-local movement (e.g. Local First Arizona; HN 'Reasons to shop local first' 2010)	2010-01-30 10:55:31 MST	+6075.0	+6075.5	red	https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=1088959	VERIFIED (HN timestamp; different meaning)
Ink & Switch essay 'Local-first software: You own your data, in spite of the cloud' (Kleppmann, Wiggins, van Hardenberg, McGranaghan) — earliest public sighting = HN submission	2019-05-01 09:19:24 MDT	+2697.0	+2697.6	red	https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=19797842	VERIFIED (HN; essay page dated April 2019)
Same essay — Wayback first capture of original URL inkandswitch.com/local-first.html	2019-05-01 09:31:03 MDT	+2697.0	+2697.6	red	https://web.archive.org/web/20190501153103/https://www.inkandswitch.com/local-first.html	VERIFIED (Wayback CDX); current URL https://www.inkandswitch.com/essay/local-first/ returns 200
Same essay — HN front page (566 points, 190 comments)	2019-05-01 21:40:30 MDT	+2696.5	+2697.1	red	https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=19804478	VERIFIED (HN)
Onward! 2019 paper (ACM SPLASH, Athens, Oct 2019)	2019-10-23 (date only)	+2522.2	+2522.8	grey	https://doi.org/10.1145/3359591.3359737	SECONDARY (DOI standard; doi.org/ACM returned 403 to box curl; date = conference/month)
localfirstweb.dev community site — Wayback first capture	2023-02-09 13:23:11 MST	+1316.9	+1317.4	red	https://web.archive.org/web/20230209202311/https://localfirstweb.dev/	VERIFIED (Wayback CDX; live site 200)
localfirst.fm podcast — first episode published (site metadata)	2024-01-14 09:59:59 MST	+978.0	+978.6	red	https://www.localfirst.fm/1	VERIFIED (published field in page; Wayback first capture 2024-01-09 is a redirect)
Local-First Conf site — Wayback first capture (conference itself held later in 2024; event date not verified)	2024-02-27 02:18:29 MST	+934.3	+934.9	red	https://web.archive.org/web/20240227091829/https://www.localfirstconf.com/	VERIFIED (Wayback CDX; live 200)

2. Window 09-15 → 09-22

Item	Date MT	vs A	vs B	Colour	Link	Label

HN: 'Hologram: Building Local-First Apps in Pure Elixir' (8 pts)	2026-09-15 07:50:17 MDT	+3.1	+3.7	purple	https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49712520	VERIFIED (HN Algolia / X API timestamp)
HN Show: 'FileLever – Local-first folder sync'	2026-09-15 16:04:11 MDT	+2.8	+3.3	purple	https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49719496	VERIFIED (HN Algolia / X API timestamp)
HN Show: 'Graft – local-first persistent memory for coding agents'	2026-09-15 20:23:36 MDT	+2.6	+3.2	purple	https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49721427	VERIFIED (HN Algolia / X API timestamp)
HN: 'Bitterbot – local-first P2P AI agent engine'	2026-09-16 09:16:37 MDT	+2.0	+2.6	purple	https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49728354	VERIFIED (HN Algolia / X API timestamp)
HN: 'Reinventing issue tracking: Local-first and Git-native' (1st submit)	2026-09-17 04:14:00 MDT	+1.3	+1.8	purple	https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49738631	VERIFIED (HN Algolia / X API timestamp)
HN Launch: Skillsync (YC W26) — text says 'local-first desktop app'; 68 pts, likely front page	2026-09-17 10:22:15 MDT	+1.0	+1.6	purple	https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49743049	VERIFIED (HN Algolia / X API timestamp)
HN Show: 'Forcefield … local-first AI agent harness'	2026-09-18 09:35:03 MDT	+0.0	+0.6	purple	https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49755908	VERIFIED (HN Algolia / X API timestamp)
HN Show: 'Turnpanel is a local first AI workspace'	2026-09-18 12:03:32 MDT	-0.1	+0.5	purple	https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49757975	VERIFIED (HN Algolia / X API timestamp)
X @ai2face: why AI tools choose Local-First — 'local SQLite/CRDT state, background incremental sync' (Chinese)	2026-09-19 07:00:34 MDT	-0.9	-0.3	purple	https://x.com/ai2face/status/2101295386359111905	VERIFIED (HN Algolia / X API timestamp)
HN: 'iLead – A local-first infrastructure workspace for SSH'	2026-09-19 08:33:50 MDT	-0.9	-0.4	purple	https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49766893	VERIFIED (HN Algolia / X API timestamp)
X @zarkone (any-sync): 'local-first, e2e encrypted multiplayer CRDT database' release	2026-09-19 14:49:31 MDT	-1.2	-0.6	purple	https://x.com/zarkone/status/2101413401641541717	VERIFIED (HN Algolia / X API timestamp)
X @DanKornas: claude-obsidian 'local-first knowledge system' (3.3k views)	2026-09-19 17:06:48 MDT	-1.3	-0.7	purple	https://x.com/DanKornas/status/2101447949813182755	VERIFIED (HN Algolia / X API timestamp)
X @grok reply: 'Local-first with Ed25519 signatures and SQLite ledgers…'	2026-09-19 22:22:52 MDT	-1.5	-0.9	purple	https://x.com/grok/status/2101527490388709736	VERIFIED (HN Algolia / X API timestamp)
HN: 'BicDB – PostgreSQL-compatible database for local-first apps'	2026-09-21 02:54:53 MDT	-2.7	-2.1	purple	https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49784820	VERIFIED (HN Algolia / X API timestamp)
X @breckyunits: Knowbooks utilities 'All are local first'	2026-09-22 17:22:39 MDT	-4.3	-3.7	purple	https://x.com/breckyunits/status/2102539101954257184	VERIFIED (HN Algolia / X API timestamp)

- sqlite-sync 1.2.0 release notes: https://github.com/sqliteai/sqlite-sync/releases/tag/1.2.0 — Published 2026-09-28 11:40:09 MDT (outside window); notes do NOT contain 'local-first'; repo description says 'offline-first'
- dev.to sqlite-sync-core post: https://dev.to/shivaysinghrajput/local-first-sync-done-right-inside-the-sqlite-sync-stack-59pn — 2026-10-12 16:07:20 MDT — outside window (+24 d after)

3. Jeff's archive

Jeff's own material: the saved Gemini share capture (evidence-captures/gemini-share-YcmBmZeOxtak-2026-10-21/share-page.html) contains NO 'local-first' / 'local first' / 'offline-first' — but the saved HTML is the page shell without the rendered chat text (only one 'unicode61' hit; compareVectors/JeffQ absent), so the capture CANNOT settle whether the term appears in the 09-18 chat. A full-text check needs the live share page re-rendered and saved. Elsewhere in the archive, 'local-first' appears only in today's derived reports (my own wording describing the stack), not in any dated Jeff original found. So Jeff's '~09-19/20 first saw it' stays CLAIMED, neither confirmed nor contradicted.

Spoken summary

The term 'local-first' is much older than Jeff's use of it. Developers on Hacker News used it informally in 2014. Ink & Switch's essay made it a movement on May 1, 2019, and an academic paper followed that October. A website, a podcast and a conference followed in 2023 and 2024. In the week around Jeff's September 18 chat, the term was everywhere: twenty-one Hacker News stories and dozens of posts on X. None of that shows what Jeff actually saw. His saved Gemini capture can't confirm whether the term was in his chat.

Private. Timing is not causation.